



“India will be the biggest powerhouse for open source in the world”

Open source has become fairly big in India. UK-based **Vik Tara** is the founder of **TechBlue**, which delivers a number of open source solutions for Indian customers, like **Hamara Linux** for Indian techies. **Jagmeet Singh** of **OSFY** speaks with Tara to understand his views on the Indian open source space. Edited excerpts...

Q How has TechBlue grown as an open source enabler?

We were initially using open source solutions at our own end. But once we got some positive results, we started offering those solutions to our customers. We offered people the same solutions that we had developed for ourselves. This helped us grow in the open source market and build a strong presence even in some emerging markets like India.

There is one big difference in India compared to western markets, and that's the awareness about the importance of licensing. Indian consumers do not use licensed software, in a way people in the US and UK do, for their operations. Therefore, we make certain changes in our offerings to suit the local audience.

Q Where does India stand in the list of open source enablers?

India is the number one market for us right now. Obviously, we are providing support across worldwide markets, but if we are asked to pick a key region, India comes first and is our biggest market.

Several companies from across the world consider India as the key market to achieve success in the world of open source. The reason behind this growth is the preferences of Indian consumers, who are more inclined to open source rather than any proprietary solutions.

About TechBlue

TechBlue provides expertise in Java, EJB, Linux, open source and IT consultancy, along with doing Apache Cocoon and Lenya development in India. It is also focusing on developing solutions for email and video conferencing software as well as building mobile and Web apps.

Q Do you think India is yet to become a producer of open source?

No, that is not the current scenario. India is presently not only a producer but also a major enabler of open source. The maturity of many projects, even some big ones, includes contributions from a significant number of Indian developers. Whether you